👩‍🏫 Staff Guide · Horticulture 1 · Unit 5 Soil & Nutrients (Level 1)

Level 1 = about 2nd-grade reading, with emoji and pictures. SLE students stay in the class teacher's lesson and use these pieces next to it: same topics, same order, same points.

1. How the pieces line up

Gen ed piece (Canvas: "Unit 5 Environmental Requirements for Good Plant Growth (textbook Unit 4): media and soil, N-P-K nutrients (definitions, excess, deficiency), deficiency photo research, soil texture jar test, self-evaluation questions")	**Level 1 piece**
Textbook Unit 4 + Plant Media and Nutrition	Slides "Plants Need", "Growing Media" + notes A (facts rewritten)
Soil Analysis Parts 1-2 (jar test)	Soil Jar Test lab packet + notes B
Plant Nutrition Definitions (N-P-K, excess, deficiency)	Slides + notes C
Deficiency photo research	Slide "Deficiency Signs"
Unit 4 SE questions (16)	Modified quiz
Class slides	Deck: 16 slides, Words to Know first, "point to the picture" checks, recap
Her worksheets (grouped into lessons)	Guided notes: 15 items + key
Class quiz / notes check	Quiz: 8 questions + key
Vocabulary	9 picture cards (cut apart)
—	1 game on the class site: 10 questions + a matching round

2. Supports built in

- **Read aloud** every line; student may point, say, or circle (point = full answer)
- One idea per slide; big pictures; 2–3 picture choices
- Jar test math: Level 1 says which layer is biggest; Level 2 uses a calculator frame
- Color anchors: 🟢 N, 🟣 P, 🟠 K

3. Add these as the IEP allows

- Read-aloud · extended time · separate setting
- Printed slides · videos paused at the "look for" part
- Cover one choice to make it 2

4. What to grade

- Soil analysis: Level 1 = photo + 'biggest layer'; Level 2 = layer % with calculator
- **Notes**: same points as her worksheets for that lesson when complete.
- **Quiz**: score, then scale to the class points.
- These are **modifications** (less content). The IEP must allow modified grading. Check with the case manager.

5. Who to ask

- Mr. Driver (SLE): changes and IEP questions.
- Facts we could not confirm in her files say "check with the class teacher".

🚧 Under construction (check with the class teacher)

- **Unit 4 SE question text**: The 16 self-evaluation questions are in the textbook scan only; our quiz is team-written.
- **Plant Media and Nutrition**: Title only in the export.

⚠️ Safety: tools and plants

- **Tools**: students may use all tools (pruners, knives, floral wire, low-temp glue guns) **with an adult right there**. Staff hand tools out, stay at the station, and count them back in. Cut-resistant gloves if possible.
- **Poinsettia sap** is milky and can irritate skin and eyes. Gloves on, no rubbing eyes, wash hands after.
- **Latex**: poinsettias are in the latex family. Students with a latex allergy wear non-latex (nitrile) gloves or skip handling; check health plans.
- **Bees and pollen**: check IEP/health plans for bee-sting or pollen allergies and know where the EpiPen is before greenhouse work.
- **Mouths**: no plants, soil, seeds, berries, fertilizer or rooting hormone in mouths. Students who mouth objects or have pica need one-to-one eyes in the greenhouse. Many plants (holly and mistletoe berries, some houseplants) are poisonous.
- **Chemicals**: rooting hormone and fertilizer with gloves, then wash hands. Pesticides and growth regulators are staff/teacher only; students never spray or handle them.
- **Greenhouse**: wet floors and hoses (slips), heat (water breaks), wet dry potting mix first (dust).